

1. GitHub Repo Stats

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-07T07:25:14+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/7/github-repo-stats/#atom-everything>

Tool: GitHub Repo Stats One of the things I always look for when evaluating a new GitHub repository is the number of commits it has... but that number isn't visible on GitHub's mobile site layout. I built this tool to fix that, using this prompt: Given a GitHub repo URL or foo/bar repo ID show information about that repo absorbed via wither REST or graphql CORS fetch() including the number of commits in the repo and other useful stats Example output for simonw/datasette and simonw/llm . Tags: github

2. April 2026 newsletter

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-04T22:38:36+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/4/april-newsletter/#atom-everything>

I just sent out the April edition of my sponsors-only monthly newsletter . If you are a sponsor (or if you start a sponsorship now) you can access it here . In this month's newsletter: Opus 4.7 and GPT-5.5, both with price increases Claude Mythos and LLM security research ChatGPT Images 2.0 More model releases Other highlights from my blog What I'm using, April 2026 edition Here's a copy of the March newsletter as a preview of what you'll get. Pay \$10/month to stay a month ahead of the free copy! Tags: newsletter

3. TRE Python binding ? ReDoS robustness demo

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-04T17:52:00+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/4/tre-python-binding/#atom-everything>

Research: TRE Python binding ? ReDoS robustness demo If it's good enough for antirez to add to Redis I figured Ville Laurikari's TRE regular expression engine was worth exploring in a little more detail. I had Claude Code build an experimental Python binding (it used ctypes) and try some malicious regular expression attacks against the library. TRE handles those much better than Python's standard library implementation, thanks mainly to the lack of support for backtracking. Tags: security , python , regular-expressions , c , ctypes

4. Adobe?s ?Modern? User Interface Is Just Webpages

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-05T02:17:00Z

Link: <https://pxlrv.com/linklog/adobe-modern-user-interface/>

Nick Heer: If you do a little poking around in Adobe?s application bundles, a key reason for the jankiness of these user interfaces becomes apparent: it is because they are little webpages. These dialog boxes are HTML files that reference a chunky CSS file and oodles of JavaScript, and appear to be built with React. [...] I was going to write about how this stuff should have been tried with people who actually use Adobe?s apps in a high-pressure environment, but I am sure it was and, also, it does not matter. Wichary has it right. These are fundamental principles of user interface design that Adobe is ignoring because its internal tooling has taken precedence. I will quibble only with this line from Heer?s post: Also, Adobe?s interface has always been unique and not quite at home on either MacOS or Windows. You have to go back to the 1990s and classic Mac OS, but Adobe?s best apps used to have exemplary native UIs. Apps like Photoshop helped push the state of the art in Mac UI forward. Tabbed palettes were a revelation. Fire up, say, Photoshop 3.0 on MacOS 7.6 and see what I mean. Also worth noting is how much this new ?modern? UI isn?t just subjectively ugly, it?s objectively bre...

5. App Store Search Ads and the Slippery Slope

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-04T21:09:21Z

Link: <https://blog.thinktapwork.com/post/812803664980967425/ios-app-store-search-is-rotten>

Jeremy Provost, on the blog for Think Tap Work, his mobile app development company: iOS App

Store search is no longer about relevance. It's about ad inventory. With Apple's introduction of a second search ad, for any query where we weren't #1, we've effectively moved down one position. [...] If you're counting at home, roughly 70% of the interface is covered in ads. A casino ad, to boot. That was a month ago. Two weeks later, he posted a follow-up, showing the effect on Think Tap Work's apps in the App Store: I wanted to share some updated numbers from our own apps. To isolate the impact, these numbers only include App Store Search impressions from iOS devices, comparing Mar 26-Apr 8 to the prior two weeks. In other words: how much visibility we've lost in search. Morpho Converter : 26% decrease Pop Out Timer : 23% decrease Attendant for Zoom : 30% decrease Participant : 3% increase. As previously mentioned, we advertise Participant using Search Ads. It's not surprising that it might be getting a bump from this change. The screenshot in his follow-up shows another casino ad, this time in a search for "Roblox". Kinda gross. Here's Wikipedia on the "Zero-One-Infinity Rule": The...

6. "Noir, Japan's Hard-Boiled Bittersweet Answer to Oreos"

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-04T19:48:48Z

Link: <https://tokyopaladin.substack.com/p/the-japanese-oreo-noir-kills-the>

Jake Adelstein (author of Tokyo Vice) on his blog Tokyo Paladin: For decades, Japan's Oreos weren't made by Nabisco at all. They were produced domestically by Yamazaki Biscuits, under a licensing arrangement with what eventually became Mondelez International. This was, by most accounts, a reasonable arrangement. The cookies were local. The quality was consistent. Nobody was complaining. Then Mondelez did what corporations do when things are working fine. The license expired, and Mondelez moved production of the Oreos it sells in Japan to China, exporting them to Japanese wholesalers and retailers. A cost decision. A spreadsheet decision. The kind of decision made in a room with no windows and a very good projector. Sensitive Japanese consumers noticed quickly "the taste had changed. Into that opening stepped the Noir, inheriting the flavor the old Oreo had left behind. Yamazaki Biscuits launched Noir in December 2017 as the successor nobody had officially asked for and everybody apparently wanted. I have a great affinity for Newman-O's, which I've previously described as "the cookies Oreos pretend to be". Turns out though I've mostly sung the praises of Newman-O's on my podcast...

7. Using a Python 3 LSP server with Python 2 code works (more or less)

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-09T21:58:36Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/python/Python2WithPython3LSP>

I still have a certain amount of Python 2 code, both for work and for personal projects (for example, DWiki, the wiki software behind this blog; it will be Python 3 someday, but not so far). For a long time, I've preferred to do any significant editing of Python code in GNU Emacs, my normal choice for a superintelligent editor, and for a while, I've used LSP based Python editing. There's a very old LSP server for Python 2, but all of the Python LSP servers you actually want to use are specifically for Python 3, and recently I hit a problem that made me turn off the Python 2 LSP server. Since then I've been editing my Python 2 code (cautiously) with pylsp (my normal Python 3 LSP server) and recently, a little bit with 'ruff'. Somewhat to my surprise, this has more or less worked. My minimum standard for more or less working is that the LSP doesn't malfunction obviously or deluge me with errors and other diagnostics that aren't applicable because it's applying Python 3 rules to Python 2 code. It's even better if the LSP can actually identify real problems, such as misspelled variable names or function names, and recently I've had pylsp do that for some of my code (code that was...

8. Notes on using GNU Emacs' Tramp system in an unusual shell environment

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-09T02:10:47Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/programming/EmacsTrampNotes>

Tramp is a famous and often praised GNU Emacs system for editing remote files; lots of people will call it one of Emacs' compelling features. I've always had a decidedly different view of Tramp because Tramp has mostly not worked for me in opaque ways. I recently took another run at getting Tramp working (so I could have an informed opinion on why I'm not a fan), and in the process I've learned a bunch of things that I don't want to forget. Although Tramp has a bunch

of ways to get access to files remotely ('methods' in Tramp jargon), the dominant way is for Tramp to SSH in to the remote system and do stuff. In order to work with your remote shell, Tramp really wants your login on the remote system to have a conventional shell environment, ideally one that uses the Bourne shell (especially Bash). (But see Remote shell setup hints and the Tramp FAQ .) In specific, Tramp has requirements for its ssh method in a stock setup: Your shell must have a relatively conventional shell prompt. Defining this is beyond the scope of this entry; see the definition of tramp-shell-prompt-pattern in tramp.el . Your shell must accept and use backslash quoting of more or less arbitrary characters in c...

9. Book Review: The Names by Florence Knapp ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sat, 09 May 2026 11:34:20 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/book-review-the-names-by-florence-knapp/>

This has an excellent narrative structure, some beautiful prose, and I just didn't enjoy it. The story is Sliding Doors meets Same Time Next Year mixed with a distressing amount of domestic violence. A mother faces a difficult choice. Should she name her child after her abusive and violent husband? In one strand she does, in another she doesn't, and in the third she makes a compromise. We?

10. The Mismeasure of Open Source

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-09T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/09/the-mismeasure-of-open-source.html>

Every attempt to score open source projects for criticality, risk, or funding need ends up built on roughly the same dozen signals, because those are the dozen signals you can get from a registry API and the GitHub REST endpoints in an afternoon. I wrote earlier this week about the 2015 CII census, whose formula scored xz-utils a 6 out of 13 and let it sink to row 254, and which nonetheless got more right than it's usually given credit for. Ten years on there are several successor efforts running, from foundations, academics, and funders, and I've contributed data to most of them. With far more data and far more people working on the problem they are still largely built on the same inputs, so they inherit most of the same blind spots plus a few new ones, and I wanted to write those down in one place without picking on any single model. Missing read as zero The most consequential mistake is treating the absence of a signal as a low value of that signal. Go modules are fetched from version control via a proxy that publishes no per-module download counts. C libraries reach machines through apt, dnf, apk, vendoring, and static linking, none of which report to anyone. If a model's entr...

11. Pluralistic: Trump's fruitless search for a goreable ox (09 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Sat, 09 May 2026 12:51:02 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/09/cossie-livvie-crissie/>

Today's links Trump's fruitless search for a goreable ox: You can keep billionaires happy, or you can fight the cost of living crisis, but not both. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Typewriter bust; Phrack's new issue; Panama Papers whistleblower speaks; The PRO Act; Zuck's new mind-control ray. Upcoming appearances: Barcelona, Berlin, Hay-on-Wye, London, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Trump's fruitless search for a goreable ox (permalink) I've got good news and bad news for Trump. The good news: you can get elected by promising to do something about the cost of living crisis, and the president actually has a lot of ways to improve people's daily costs. The bad news: everything you could do to fix working people's cost of living will make an oligarch worse off. This is the essential conundrum of Trumpismo: to keep his base happy, he needs to make their lives better; but to make their lives better, he'll have to make oligarchs angry. The oligarchs' wealth bonanza caused the cost of living crisis. Oliga...

12. Reading List 05/09/2026

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 09 May 2026 12:02:50 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-05092026>

Trapped buildings, in-home data centers, cardboard military drones, Brightline's potential bankruptcy, and more.

13. The Real Singularity is the Friends We Made Along the Way

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-05-09T00:00:00-07:00

Link: <https://geohot.github.io/blog/jekyll/update/2026/05/09/real-singularity.html>

This was in the Financial Times. I don't have a subscription, so I don't know what article it was in, or what context, or if they are in on the joke of the general absurdity of the graph or not. In case it's not super obvious which one will happen, I will bet everything I have on it basically being the blue line. The graph has a log scale, that's already exponential growth. There were old Yudkowsky / Hanson debates about FOOM, and I'm curious how I felt about them at the time. Looking back on it it's kind of embarrassing to ever have believed in the machine God at all, but there's still believers out there, and this post is aimed at you. Kind of like a getting people out of Scientology thing. I heard once that the Singularity was just the rapture for 150+ IQ people and I dismissed it as some weird envy of 150-IQ-nerds-are-right thing. Umm yea, the people saying the rapture thing were right, and belief in the rapture for nerds is now migrating down the IQ slide. There's a bunch of ways this belief manifests. There's insane hyperscaler spend on infrastructure, which is actually pretty cool and will have good effects long term when the bubble pops. The hyperscalers aren't even wrong...

14. I Will Not Add Query Strings to Your URLs

Source: Susam Pal | Published: 2026-05-09T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://susam.net/no-query-strings.html>

Last evening, a short blog post appeared in my feed reader that felt as if it spoke directly to me. It is Chris Morgan's excellent post I've banned query strings . Contents Wisdom on the Web Wander on the Web Misfeature Broken URLs Qualms Conclusion Wisdom on the Web Chris is someone whose Internet comments I have been reading for about half a decade now. I first stumbled upon his comments on Hacker News, where he left very detailed feedback on a small collection of boilerplate CSS rules I had shared there. I am by no means a web developer. I have spent most of my professional life doing systems programming in C and C++. However, developing websites and writing small HTML tools has been a long-time hobby for me. I have learnt most of my web development skills as a hobbyist by studying what other people do: first by viewing the source of websites I liked in the early 2000s, and later by occasionally getting possessed by the urge to implement a new game or tool and searching MDN Web Docs to learn whatever I needed to make it work. One problem with learning a skill this way is that you sometimes pick up habits and practices that are fashionable but not necessarily optimal or correct....

15. History of PowerDNS: 2013-2020 (Technology)

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 21 Dec 2020 20:32:58 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/history-of-powerdns-2013-2020/>

In this part of the history of PowerDNS, I talk about the technical developments from 2013 to 2020. Over these years many fascinating business & hiring developments also happened, but these are described in a separate post, part 3B of the PowerDNS History. Here are the earlier parts: Part 1, Part 2 For context, the 2013-2020 era is what I would describe as "PowerDNS 3.0" - how we grew from a one (or two) person company to a healthy and thriving department of Open-Xchange.

16. Kerstdiner in Maart

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 12 Dec 2020 15:44:11 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/kerstdiner-in-maart/>

Kerstdiner met de familie, moeten we dat nou wel of niet doen dit jaar? Ooit studeerde ik in Delft. Niet dat ik m'n studie daar afgemaakt heb, maar ik heb er toch nog wat geleerd. Een van de dingen die ik daar opgestoken heb is dat je een kerstdiner prima in maart kan houden. Studentenhuisen, jaarclubs, dispuuten en dergelijke ontdekten met regelmaat dat het moeilijk is

om een moment te vinden dat iedereen kan voor het kerstdiner.

17. COVID-19: Things We're Not Even Trying

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 08 Dec 2020 10:13:31 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/covid-things-were-not-even-trying/>

As COVID-19 drags on, I've tried to stay optimistic about scientific and medical developments. By highlighting research, I have hoped to explain (in Dutch and English) how various things will work to defeat COVID-19, and how to look out for your health. But all this time I've been frustrated about the things we are not doing, or are not doing enough of. 10th of January 2021 update: The advent of new highly transmissible variants makes this all even worse.

18. extremely low frequencies

Source: computers are bad | Published: 09 May 2026 00:00:00 UT

Link: <https://computer.rip/2026-05-09-extremely-low-frequencies.html>

The submarine is a surprisingly ancient technology?at least in its early, primitive forms. The idea is quite simple, that a well-enough-sealed boat ought to be able to submerge and resurface. It's the practicalities that make the whole thing difficult. It is generally considered that the US Civil War was the first use of submarines in combat; these were primitive machines with very limited operating endurance and navigational capabilities. These submarines were more like torpedoes: you pointed them in the right direction and hoped they went straight. The First World War benefited from tremendous advances in submarine technology. A number of experimental designs during the 19th century had built practical experience, especially in Germany, and the Germans apt use of the first modern "U-boats" had a significant military impact. British and US designs made similar advances, and submarine warfare was born. The chief advantage of the submarine is its ability to submerge and maneuver while hidden. WW1 submarines were diesel-electric or gasoline, so their submerged endurance was limited by the power supply stored onboard. Still, these submarines could operate underwater longer than any b...